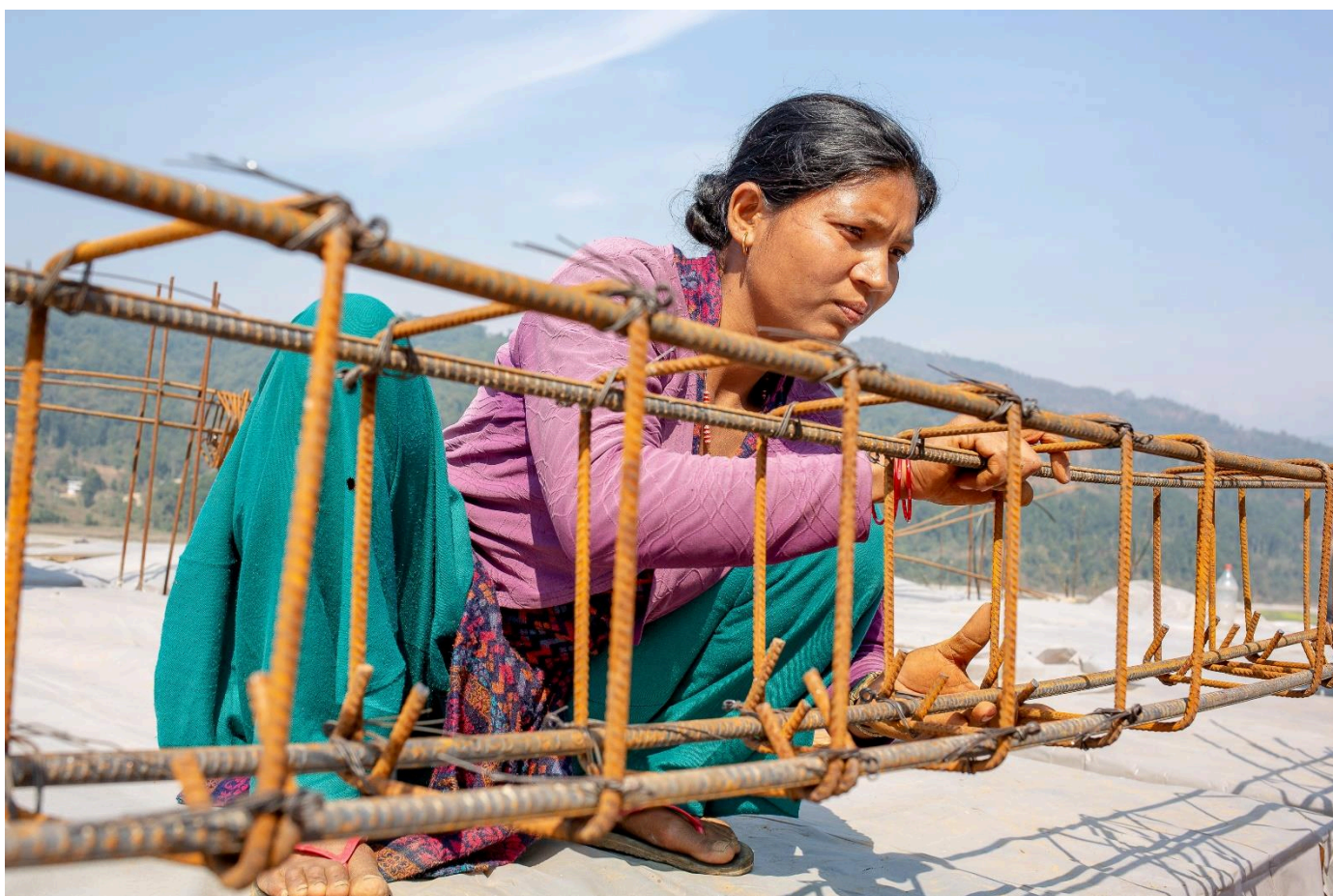


[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



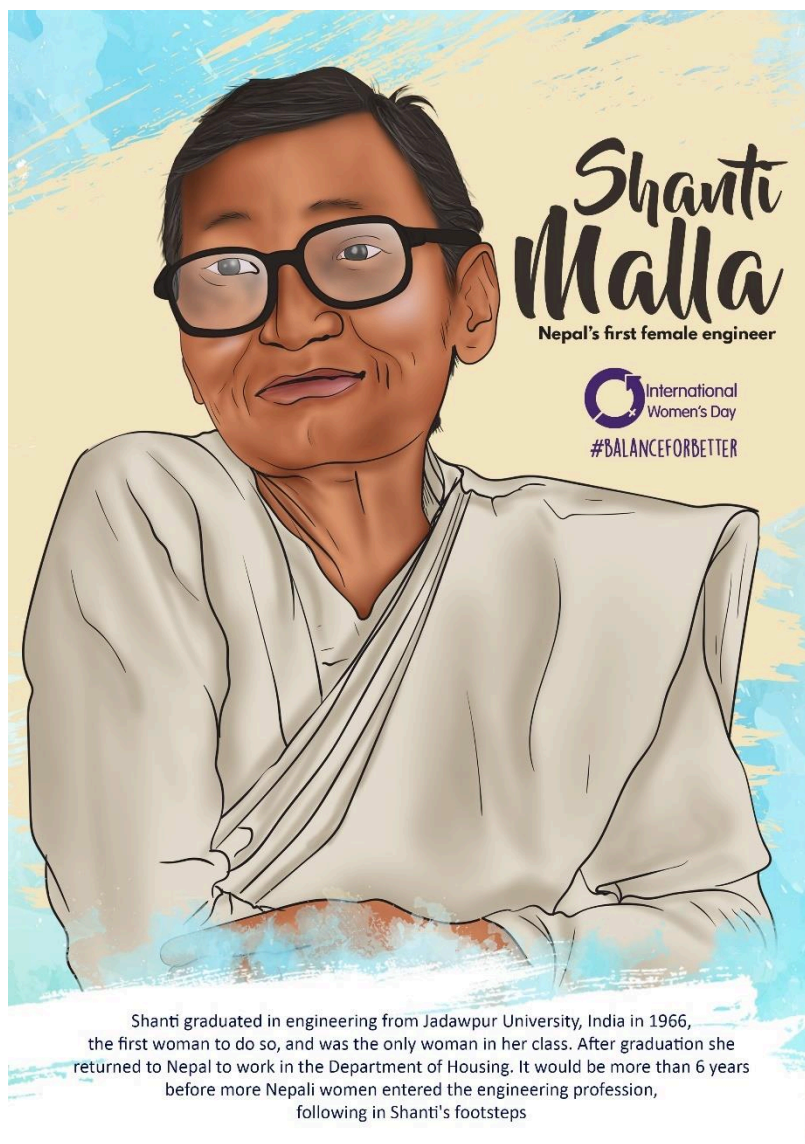
Edition No.: 101

HRRP Housing Recovery and
Reconstruction Platform
BULLETIN
18 March 2019



Ward 9, Gorkha Municipality, Gorkha: Sanju Bishwakarma is a lead mason and is known for her skill in steel fixing.

Although female masons report that some families are reluctant to hire them, many people now seek out Sanju based on her reputation for high-end work. She is also building her own home but has faced delays in receiving the GoN housing reconstruction grant due to an error in the agreement, but this is being corrected and she will then be able to receive the tranche payments. She has supported other women to come through a 50-day mason training, provided by CRS and Caritas. Photo credit: Jen Hardy/CRS.



This is one of a series of posters that HRRP put out to mark International Women's Day on 8 March. The posters highlight the achievements of eight Nepali women. The full set of posters is available, in Nepali and English, on the HRRP website [here](#).

Bulletin Publication Schedule

As the HRRP bulletin is now a monthly publication, it will be published on the Monday closest to the 15th of each month and the next four editions of the bulletin will come out on the following dates:

- 15 April
- 13 May
- 17 June
- 15 July

Featured Technical Staff Person



*Nashrul Haque Mansoor
Engineer, Kamalamai-5, Sindhuli*

This week's featured technical staff person is Nashrul Haque Mansoor. Nashrul is from Parsa and has been working as an NRA inspection engineer since 25 April 2016.

In addition to carrying out inspections and providing technical support to households and masons, Nashrul is the reconstruction focal point for Kamalamai Rural Municipality.

His experience of working on the reconstruction has been positive, especially as households and masons and have been very open to his advice and have constructed accordingly. He shares that the timber manual has been an important step for the area and the disbursement of the tranches has progressed because of this.

Highlights

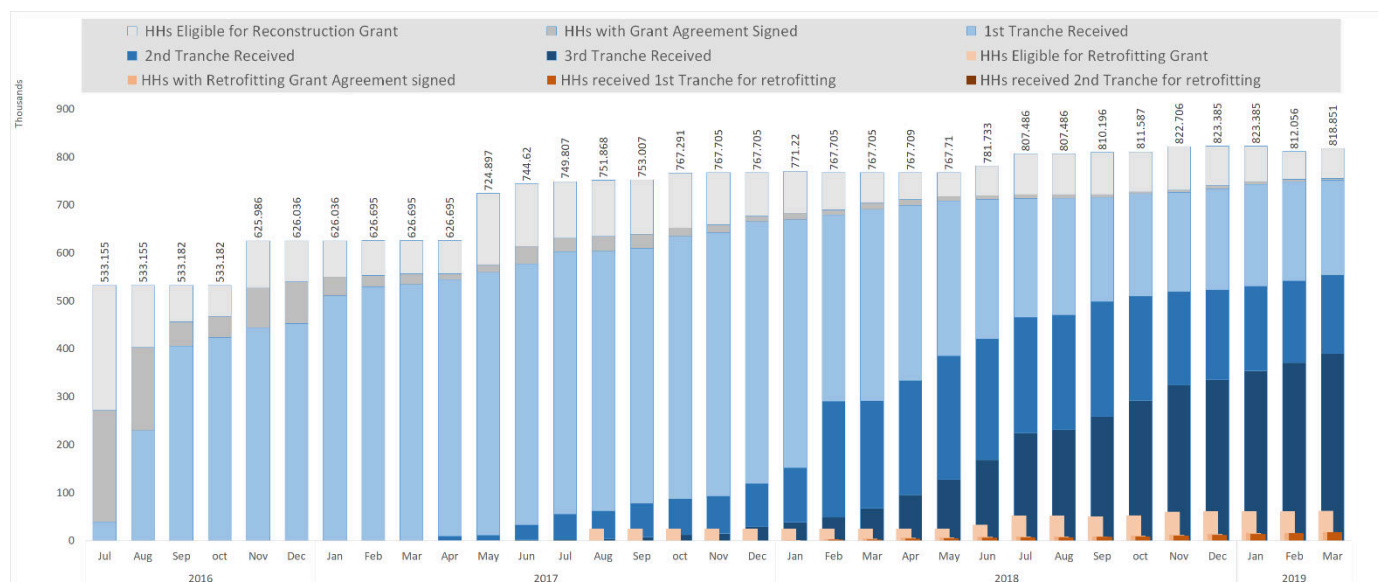
- Update on support to vulnerable households
 - Inspection engineers strike across 32 earthquake affected districts
 - NRA notice regarding resurvey starting 29 March. N.B. last date to register grievances is 15 May.
 - [HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey Round 4 Report](#)
 - [Durable Solutions Dashboard](#) - updates on relocation and geo-hazards
 - Summary of Nepal Red Cross Society, 'Movement-Wide lessons learned workshop of the Nepal Post 2015 Earthquake Operation', Kathmandu, 5-7 March
-

National Updates

NRA, CLPIU GMALI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 18 March:

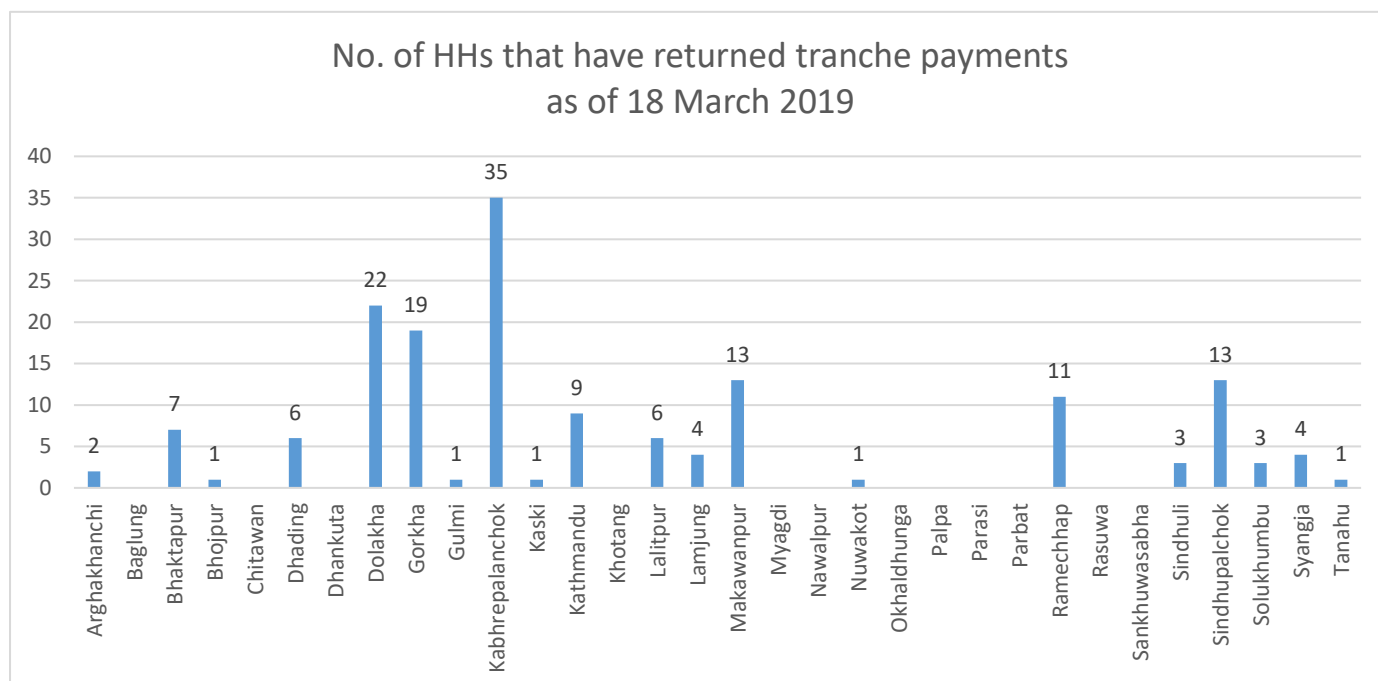
Reconstruction Grant	4 February	18 February	18 March
Total No. Eligible HHs	811,221*	812,056	818,851
HHs Enrolled	751,790	754,204	756,127
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	746,853	749,296	751,986
HHs Applied for 2 nd Tranche	557,904	564,639	574,043
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	536,030	541,774	554,775
Non-compliant at 2 nd Tranche	4,713	4,728	4,519
HHs Applied for 3 rd Tranche	395,255	402,852	416,491
HHs Received 3 rd Tranche	363,640	371,279	390,448
Non-compliant at 3 rd Tranche	2,708	2,931	2,327
Houses Completed	365,831	370,250	378,935
HHs with Completion Certificate	4,462	5,964	7,465
Retrofit Grant	4 February	18 February	18 March
Total No. Eligible HHs	61,836	61,860	63,019
HHs Enrolled	16,695	17,198	18,342
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	15,672	16,186	17,437
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	23	27	27

*the total number of households eligible for the GoN housing reconstruction grant has decreased because there had been an error in the numbers reported from Sindhuli and this has now been corrected.



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMALI CLPIU, and Building CLPIU data from July 2016 to 18 March 2019.

Tracking Return of First Tranche: numbers are based on data collected by HRRP District Coordination Teams (DCTs) through the GMALI DLPIU offices. A total of 162 households have returned tranche payments to date.



NRA Notice for Reverification and Resurvey, March 2019: the NRA will conduct a final reverification and resurvey for households missed during previous surveys, starting from 29 March. All households requiring resurvey are requested to provide their details to the engineers deployed in their respective areas within the given timeline. All local level officials are requested to support the reverification and resurvey by providing the details of the real affected persons in their respective levels. Please contact the District Level Project Implementation Unit (DLPIU) of your respective districts or the local levels for additional information regarding this. N.B. the last date for registering grievances is 15 May 2019.

राष्ट्रिय पुनर्निर्माण प्राधिकरण

सिंहदरबार, काठमाण्डौ

छुट तथा पुनः जाँच सर्वेक्षण २०७५ को

सूचना

निजी आवास पुनर्निर्माण लाभग्राहीमा सूचीकृत हुन पाउँ भनि गुनासो दर्ता गराई गुनासो सम्बोधन अन्तर्गत पहिलेको मुख्य सर्वेक्षणमा छुट भएका गुनासोकर्ताहरु, सर्वेक्षणबाट थप यकिन गर्नु पर्ने भनि तोकिएका गुनासोकर्ताहरु, छुट तथा पुनः जाँच सर्वेक्षण २०७५ मा लगत संकलन नभएका गुनासोकर्ताहरु र स्थानीय तहमा तोकिएको समयसीमा भित्र नयाँ दर्ता गरिएका गुनासोहरुको अन्तिम पटक छुट तथा पुनः जाँच सर्वेक्षण गर्ने प्राधिकरणको नीति अनुसार २०७५ चैत्र १५ देखि सम्पूर्ण भूकम्प प्रभावित जिल्लाहरुमा एकै साथ स्थानीय तहमा प्राधिकरणबाट तोकिएका प्राविधिकहरुमार्फत स्थलगत लगत संकलन गरिदछ । आ आफ्नो क्षेत्रमा खटिएका प्राविधिकहरु मार्फत तोकिएको समयमा आ आफ्नो लगत संकलन गराउनुहुन सबै गुनासोकर्ताहरुमा हादिक अनुरोध गरिन्छ । सम्पूर्ण स्थानीय तहका पदाधिकारीहरुलाई वास्तविक पीडितहरुको यथार्थपरक लगत संकलन कार्यमा सहयोग गरिदिनु हुन समेत अनुरोध गरिन्छ । यस सम्बन्धमा थप जानकारीका लागि सम्बन्धित जिल्लाका जिल्ला आयोजना कार्यान्वयन इकाईमा वा आ आफ्नो स्थानीय तहमा सम्पर्क राख्नु होला ।



राष्ट्रिय पुनर्निर्माण प्राधिकरण

सिंहदरबार, काठमाण्डौ

टोल फ्रि नं १६६०-०१- ७२०००, ९८०१५७२१११

www.nra.gov.np

Building DLPIU Engineers Strike: the engineers deployed for reconstruction had submitted a memorandum to the NRA detailing points that needed to be addressed to avoid strike action. Their points included that allowances under physical difficulty, motivation, transportation, and communication should be paid on a monthly basis. They also want identity cards, health and accident insurance, and capacity building trainings be provided to the engineers deployed in the districts. They also want a provident fund to be provided. They have requested that the NRA make provisions for the tranche payment process to be simple and easy for households. On 15 March, the NRA met with the National Engineers Welfare Protection Committee. The committee noted that the NRA has not considered their demands and as a result have set out a strike programme as follows:

1. Engineers in all 32 districts will completely halt work, including halting CS Entry, from 17 March 2019
2. Padlock the DLPIU offices in all districts from 18 March 2019
3. All engineers from the 32 districts will gather in Kathmandu at the CLPIU office on 24 March 2019



Engineers outside the DLPIU office in Gorkha which they locked today.

Three-day orientation programme on “Non-Compliance Issues and Retrofitting of Private Houses” for District Support Engineers (DSEs) and District Focal Persons, 5-7 March, Annapurna Hotel, Kathmandu: the event included district-wise presentations by DSEs on non-compliance issues, reasons for unsolved cases, recommendations and solutions, and technical problems in retrofit implementation. UNOPS and Build Change presented on their retrofit project and mason training on retrofitting. The Building DLPIUs provided updates on district data, non-compliance scenario, and retrofit status. Building CLPIU shared existing guidelines and documents. The NRA provided an overview of the government policy on retrofit and reconstruction and discussed the way forward.

Nepal Red Cross Society, ‘Movement-Wide lessons learned workshop of the Nepal Post 2015 Earthquake Operation’, Kathmandu, 5-7 March: the workshop consisted of two days of technical sessions, and one day for a plenary and overall discussion of key findings and lessons learned. The objectives of the workshop were:

- To generate key lessons learned related to the most significant achievements and best practices under Movement-Wide Recovery Plan “One Plan” that can be used by stakeholders in future contexts, not only in Nepal but also for similar large-scale operations within the Movement.

- To identify how key contributions generated through the operations can be sustained, broadened/up-scaled to the wider Nepal Red Cross Society development programming, as part of the wider humanitarian and development system in the country.
- To serve as inputs session for future planning and coordination of the Movement programmes in Nepal.

On the third day of workshop, there was a panel discussion on the topic 'Learning together from the Post Earthquake 2015 Experience' where HRRP shared experience and recommendations as one of the panel members. Panel members were Loren Lockwood-HRRP National Technical Coordinator, Dr. Ram Thapaliya- Chair of Institute of Crisis/Disaster Management (Tribhuvan University), Dr. Ramesh Guragain- NSET Deputy Executive Director and Dr. Jeevan Baniya- Assistant Director Social Science Baha. Approximately 150 people from different countries, 14 earthquake most affected districts, media, and other stakeholders took part in the workshop. The lessons shared by the panelists were as follows:

- Reconstruction takes longer than expected
- There are different types of vulnerability and factors of vulnerability and same approach does not work to address all kinds of vulnerability
- We have learning with various organisations, but it needs to be institutionalised to apply learning and experience for future disasters otherwise it may be lost
- It is claimed that 90% of reconstructed houses are compliant but in 3-4 years' time, people will start readjusting houses as per their need which will make them more vulnerable
- Social Mobilisers were not hired by government, but they could have played a great role to minimise the communication gap (missed opportunity)
- It took 1-3 years to communicate flexibility in design
- Ineffective communication on possible retrofitting (missed opportunity)
- Locally adapted models work more effectively to increase households access to services, for example revolving fund for access to grant
- Training does not mean retention, especially for women

The panelist made a number of recommendations, including:

- Different geographical areas have different vulnerabilities so policy and programme should be designed based on context
- Solutions must be delivered with great patience
- Different agencies have different priorities. Harmonisation should be done to prioritise the needs of households
- Capture and institutionalise knowledge and experience of institutions and people engaged in reconstruction so that they will be useful for future disasters
- The support provided by government and partner organisations should be provided based on the scale of disaster. On average a large-scale disaster recovery and reconstruction takes 12 years but donors and implementers still plan for much shorter projects, which results in those that can easily engage in recovery being the ones who receive assistance, and a large number of more vulnerable who have trouble engaging in recovery left to their own devices after many years of struggling. We will see these people falling further into poverty in the coming years here in Nepal. Hence, there should be consideration to have longer term programme for appropriate recovery and reconstruction.
- Allocate significant resources for social technical assistance

The panelists suggested the following actions:

- Communication, command, and control should be on the same page
- Increase realisation- Each level of government should have their policy with provision of DRM Act, National DRRM Policy and international policies.
- There should be proper translation of policies and provisions for dissemination to households
- Only technical support does not work
- Consider the scale of response

- Consider the timeframe of a recovery
- Consider the Government's contribution to the response and look at what might compliment this contribution most effectively.

Women in Construction Discussion Group, 15 March: this was the first in a series of discussions on the challenges, resources, lessons learned, and ideas to promote the careers of women in the construction industry in Nepal and gender equality in the construction/infrastructure sector more widely. The event was organised by UNOPS, in collaboration with UN Women, ILO, and WFP. The event started with a speech by the guest speaker for the event, Director of Ambe Steel and Construction company, Ms. Shiwani Neupane, who shared her experience being the only female head in this sector. There were then group discussion sessions, where topics were allotted to each table, and participants were provided with 15 mins each to come up with solutions, suggestions, and personal experiences. The topics discussed were:

- **Creating a supportive work environment in construction** – with a special focus on how to make the work environment safer and welcoming for women. Many suggestions were made regarding paid maternity leave, in particular that private contractors need to be provided with some kind of incentive so that they make sure they provide maternity leave facilities for mothers. Other suggestions were that proper toilet facilities are necessary for women in the work place and a safe space should be provided for childcare and breastfeeding.
- **Sexual harassment, safety and security, gender-based violence** – special consideration needs to be made for these issues in the construction sector, as well as what mechanisms can be set up to provide a safe and comfortable way for women to report such harassments.
- **Women's participation in technical fields, like construction and STEM subjects** – how can more female participation and recruitment in STEM related fields be encouraged, and what incentives can be provided.
- **Success in construction work led by women** – need to highlight the benefit that can be gained by women participating in reconstruction.

Vulnerable Support Working Group Meetings, 19 and 22 February: a roundtable was held on 19 February to bring together Partner Organisations (POs) working on the reconstruction to discuss emerging recommendations and action points and a way forward for the working group. The round table included presentations from various POs and then the participants were split into groups for group work on identifying key advocacy points which can be further developed into an advocacy strategy. On 22 February, the VSWG co-chairs (DFID and SDC) met with the NRA to present the VSWG's work and the results of the round table. The NRA agreed with the issues and challenges presented and with the recommendations. The CEO shared that all municipalities have been instructed to verify the vulnerable households list and collect information on households that have not been able to reconstruct. The cabinet has approved the 50,000 NPRs top-up support for vulnerable households and the NRA is in the process of amending the grant disbursement guidelines for the distribution of the top-up. The World Bank has agreed to provide technical assistance to all districts through local government. Teams of engineers, mobile masons, and social mobilisers are being recruited and will be deployed through the World Bank support. The CEO also shared that NRA is working on identifying the capacity of local bodies and designing the guidelines and processes for the support to vulnerable HHs based on their available capacities.

District & Municipal Updates

Hollow Concrete Block Manual Orientations: half day orientation sessions on the [Hollow Concrete Block \(HCB\) manual](#), recently published by the NRA, are being conducted at district level for district technical staff from NRA, POs, and other government bodies. The main objective of the orientation is to disseminate the manual and to orient technical staff on the use of the inspection check list. A total of 22 orientations are planned in the districts and so far orientations have been completed in Dhading, Dolakha, Gorkha, Makwanpur, Nuwakot, Ramechhap, Rasuwa, Sindhuli, and Sindhupalchok. Orientations in other districts are planned as follows: Bhaktapur 19 March, Kavrepalanchok 20-21 March, Kathmandu 26 March, and Lalitpur 1st week of April 2019.

Training of Trainers on Construction of Earthquake Resistant Buildings, 11-17 March, Nuwakot: two parallel 7 day trainings were carried out for technical staff in the district. The training was jointly organised by Building CLPIU, NSET, and HRRP.

Light Timber/Steel Frame Structure Manual Training, 13 and 14 March, Sindhuli: this training, for technical staff working in the district, was jointly organised by Building DLPIU and Swiss Contact, with technical support from HRRP. This is the third training on the timber manual that has been conducted in Sindhuli. The district has more than 3,000 timber houses. Nashrul Haque Mansoor, the featured technical staff person in this edition of the bulletin, shares more on his experience using the timber manual in his work in Sindhuli in the 'Case Studies' section below.

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 15 February – 14 March 2019: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Dhading (18 February), Sindhuli (18 February), Dolakha (20 February), Ramechhap (27 February), Gorkha (27 February), Nuwakot (27 February), Rasuwa (3 March), and Kavrepalanchok (12 March). Municipal level meetings took place in municipalities and wards across Dhading, Dolakha, Gorkha, Kavrepalanchok, Lalitpur, Ramechhap, Rasuwa, Sindhuli, and Sindhupalchok. Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Dhading**, the district GMALI office provided an update on tranche disbursement progress. Of the 4,068 households eligible for the retrofit grant, 321 have signed the partnership agreement and received the first tranche and none have received the second tranche. CARE Nepal with SAHAS Nepal are providing housing construction support for 152 vulnerable families. NSET Baliyo Ghar has supported 19,240 households through technical assistance. Also, shared the status of single room survey conducted in 10 VDCs in the district. Purnima Project (DFID and Mott MacDonald) is focused on community infrastructure and working with various organisations; WFP for trails, OXFAM and DCA on water supply, and GEOC provide engineering support for schools and suspension bridge. Durable Solutions shared that 193 cases out of 388 regarding resettlement and landless have been resolved.
- In **Sindhuli**, it was decided in the meeting that banks will deposit the grant amount in people's account within three days of receipt of the cheque. In case of new beneficiaries, GMALI DLPIU will provide all information to the bank so that the bank will open the account as soon as possible. The banks will pay the amount only to the person mentioned in the grant agreement as per details mentioned in the grant agreement. After depositing money to the beneficiaries' account, all the banks shall upload the details in the MIS database as early as possible. GMALI DLPIU will send both a hard copy and soft copy of the beneficiary's detail along with the cheque to the bank.
- In **Dolakha**, a task force was formed to work towards speeding up reconstruction and to declare wards/settlements as reconstruction completed areas. The task force is led by Ms. Rita Lamsal, section officer GMALI, and other members are representatives of the concerned wards, Building DLPIU, Caritas, UNDP, DSE, RDTA, NSET, and HRRP.
- In **Ramechhap**, Building DLPIU shared that 1,725 non-compliant cases have been registered, 1,485 have been recommended for correction by DSE and 860 have already applied correction measures. HELVETAS is focusing on technical support to home owners and skills training for earthquake house reconstruction and future safe construction. Medair mainly worked through aarma parma system (cluster system) where community worked to construct houses on a rotational basis and 1,158 houses out of a target of 1,312 have been completed. Medair is working towards project closure through community meetings, monitoring visits with wards to find if any HHs have not started or stopped construction, completion certificate distribution, documentation, reporting, handover, and exit meeting at the Rural Municipality. Durable Solutions shared that 150 households have been identified as vulnerable living in hazard prone areas. 49 beneficiaries have constructed houses in these vulnerable locations. Kam for Sud is providing technical support where 750 houses have been completed and supporting construction of school and health post as well. NRCS completed its activities and is working on a handover process to GMALI and local level.

- In **Gorkha**, the main decision made during the meeting was to expediate the CS entry and PA digitisation work by forming a team of MIS Officer from DLPIU, MIS Specialist from EHRP, Information Management Officer from HRRP, additional one more support person from GMALI and, also made decision to request POs, if necessary. The meeting also decided that POs should submit their progress report at the end of every month both in hard copy and e-copy to HRRP or GMALI which will be tracked by GMALI.
- In **Nuwakot**, OXFAM has completed support to relocation of 50 HHs from Uleni, Bhalche, and Lachyang. OXFAM, through implementing partners Sahayata Samajik Sanstha, KCDC, and CARDSN, is also supporting displaced families to settle in Bidur, Kharanitar, and Lachyang. 381 HHs were identified as living in geo hazard area by the NRA and of these 207 HHs have purchased land in safe areas, 60 HHs had already constructed houses in safe areas, 82 have safe land and 6 have constructed houses in their other lands. Out of the 77 landless HHs, 44 HHs are planning to move to an integrated settlement in Bidur Municipality.
- In **Rasuwa**, POs presented their activities along with a one pager report. The housing reconstruction process is coming to an end but other sector reconstruction activities like WASH, livelihood, resettlement of displaced households, maintenance of different sub-ways is going on with few of the activities just started. GMALI Chief thanked all the POs for their support in achieving good reconstruction progress in the district and requested similar support in other sector activities too.
- In **Kavrepalanchok**, DLPIU has request all municipalities to collect data on houses constructed immediately after the earthquake, before the mobilisation of NRA technical persons. As per the reconciliation report from DLPIU and NRA MIS, there are total of 294 duplications, beneficiaries receiving first tranche from the Government and the POs. The duplication verification process with various POs is going on. There is also variance in data reported by POs at district, national level and in comparison, with the banks, for instance, inspection data of few POs have been reported at GMALI but not DLPIU. In regard to vulnerable households, some of them are dead and their family members are also vulnerable as per NRA guideline, GMALI has requested Municipalities to verify the vulnerable list. Since no progress has been made with final inspection and distribution of completion certificates, DLPIU and Caritas Nepal will follow up on this. GMALI and HRRP will also coordinate for any possibility of conducting orientation/meetings at the Municipal level.
- **Wards 1 & 8, Dhulikhel Municipality, Kavrepalanchok, 15 Feb 2019:** main concerns raised were delay in tranche release and files missing at DLPIUs, non-compliant houses mainly constructed immediately after the earthquake and beneficiaries not willing to apply correction measures suggested by DSE. It was reported that reconstruction rate in Dhulikhel Municipality is slow as most of the beneficiaries are not interested in reconstruction. Mainly in core city areas (ward 6 and 7) most beneficiaries have not started construction due to issues on demolishing the damaged houses. There was request on support needed to handle grievance and support to the vulnerable beneficiaries.
- **Ajirkot Rural Municipality, Gorkha, 18 Feb 2019:** Government of India (GoI) funded Nepal Housing Reconstruction Project (NHRP) presented the reconstruction status of their supported wards and JICA funded EHRP presented the reconstruction status of their supported wards of Ajirkot Rural Municipality. The Municipal Chief shared that elderly people have not been included in reconstruction beneficiaries list since their children have home in other places like Kathmandu or Chitwan. He further shared that those elderly people should be included in reconstruction beneficiaries list and supported for housing reconstruction. He also requested all the stakeholders to seriously work to complete the reconstruction work in time. He also instructed everyone involved to have more follow up with beneficiaries to push the reconstruction progress. Some of the issues discussed were duplication in beneficiaries, delay in tranche disbursement by banks, list of people with houses in other places. GMALI Chief assured to support removal of non-beneficiaries from the housing grant list and address the issues related to people with houses in other places.
- **Wards 1, 3, 5 & 6, Tripurasundari Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok, 18 -21 Feb 2019:** the most common issues raised were lack of presence of technical staff in the field causing delay in tranche distribution to the beneficiaries, poor internet service in these wards delaying CS entry and delay in tranche disbursement by the banks. In **ward 1**, the reconstruction progress is poor, there are few beneficiaries who have received tranches despite not starting the reconstruction and few beneficiaries have received tranches though their houses are non-compliant. In **ward 3**, it was reported that the Chief received

pressure from the beneficiaries to approve the attendance of technical staff so that the technical staff would approve their houses. Due to the lack of technical awareness coupled with the lack of presence of technical staff, many non-compliant houses have been constructed in ward 3, majority of which have four-inch partition walls in load bearing structure. In **ward 5**, most beneficiaries are migrant workers, villages are inhabited by old people thus, technical persons find it difficult to identify the beneficiaries. Technical staff also noted many non-compliant houses in ward 5 that are difficult to apply correction measures or retrofit. Technical persons demanded for training and Ward Chief appreciated the work of technical staffs and provided letter of appreciation to CLPIU M&E Specialist. In **ward 6**, the office was requested to maintain the attendance of technical staffs and to monitor their presence regularly.

- **Wards 1 & 2, Dudhouli Rural Municipality, Sindhuli, 19 February:** most of the houses constructed in the wards are timber structures. Households that were not included in the reconstruction beneficiaries list are waiting for resurvey by NRA. In **ward 1**, beneficiaries have not started reconstruction due to issues with land, they have been living in Elani (Government) land with no legal documents. Still beneficiaries who constructed timber structure houses have not received the third tranche. Some houses constructed before the deployment of technical persons are non-compliant and are difficult for correction. In **ward 2**, even construction of houses is completed, due to late design approval of timber structure were considered non-compliant. It was also found that many beneficiaries did not construct timber structure even it was available, due to lack of knowledge on timber construction process.
- **Ward 9, Kalinchowk Rural Municipality, Dolakha, 20 February:** some beneficiaries have jointly submitted grievances regarding their non-compliance issues in CLPIU referencing that CLPIU/Building has written a letter to DLPIU/Building to submit detail reporting of such cases. Ward representative informed about such cases, their locations and reasons behind it. It was found that some non-compliant households have done correction but not properly. DSE suggested ward engineer and houseowner to apply proper correction measures in all parts of the building to make house compliant to be eligible for subsequent tranche.
- **Jiri Municipality, Dolakha, 21 February:** meeting mainly focused on timber frame structures. About 180 timber houses in Jiri do not meet the standard as per the timber structure manual. Mayor of Jiri requested to find out a way to make them eligible for subsequent tranches. DSE requested to collect detail information on timber structure and identify issues related to timber structure. He further added that correction has to be done on an individual basis to be eligible for subsequent tranche in which support from local level is essential. In Jiri reconstruction is in good progress but due to the absence of technical persons in some wards is causing problem in forwarding the files for the tranche which is slowing the progress.
- **Ward 4, Melung Rural Municipality, Dolakha, 21 February:** main issue with non-compliance is with the attic height more than 3 feet, specified in the guideline. Beneficiaries have made taller attic height to make use of attic for storing food, grains and for other purposes. Nearly 15 households have such cases and have not received the final tranche of government grant. Many of the beneficiaries are living in the house without applying corrections and due to lack of money and masons' they are not able to do the correction as well. Few beneficiaries were found to have constructed 6 feet attic height and are using it for living.
- **Wards 2 & 11, Tinpatan Rural Municipality, Sindhuli, 21-22 February:** it was reported that beneficiaries are interested to build timber structure houses since timber is abundantly available. In **ward 2**, there are beneficiaries who want to change from retrofit to full reconstruction beneficiaries but are unknown of the procedure. About 75% of beneficiaries are included in retrofit list through the grievance but they are not willing to retrofit their houses. In **ward 11**, more than 40% houses constructed are timber frame structure. Some timber structure houses constructed in a traditional way have not been approved and not included in the timber structure manual so, the beneficiaries are waiting to get the third tranche of government grant.
- **Arughat Rural Municipality, Gorkha, 24 February:** HRRP in coordination with Government of India (GoI) supported Housing Reconstruction project (NHRP) Gorkha is supporting 'Reconstruction Focal Person' at Aarughat Rural Municipality. The reconstruction focal person provides day to day services to beneficiaries to facilitate reconstruction process, supports technical facilitation and coordination efforts among DLPIU

engineers and POs working in the municipality. Issues related to duplication in beneficiaries, delay in tranche disbursement by banks, list of people with houses in other places were discussed during the meeting. The municipality Chief shared that the reconstruction in Arughat is moving well but many beneficiaries are in confusion due to Budhi Gandaki Hydro power project affected area. He further appreciated the socio technical support provided by NHRP/Gol and requested stronger coordination efforts from HRRP to expedite the reconstruction process.

- **Wards 4 & 5, Aamachoodingmo Rural Municipality, Rasuwa, 25-26 February:** it was reported that 80% of households have completed reconstruction and received the third tranche. However, completion certificate distribution has not been done yet. HRRP team shared the objective of collecting information on house size and number of rooms and handed over the template to the ward technical persons. There has been construction of timber structure with CGI roofing in these wards. High rate of construction materials, price inflation and language problem resulting in information gap and interaction between the beneficiaries and technical persons were some of the issues and challenges discussed during the meeting.
- **Chisankhu Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga, 27 February:** almost all houses in the municipality are stone and mud mortar masonry structure. Beneficiaries are aware of the safe building construction and reconstruction has almost completed. Presence of technical persons was reported to be good. Some households left in previous survey are waiting for the next round of survey. Beneficiaries in retrofit list are willing to be in the full reconstruction list and construct new house.
- **Ward 2, Likhu Tamakoshi Rural Municipality, Ramechhap, 27 February:** 4 out of 681 beneficiaries identified have not signed the PA with the government, one is vulnerable and three of them are not in contact. 134 beneficiaries have been identified in the retrofitting category and till date none of them have done agreement with the government for grant. They are willing to be a full reconstruction beneficiary. A total of 23 houses have constructed as part of integrated settlement. A total of 132 households have been identified as a non-compliance issue. Among the non-compliant houses, few households are not willing to correct and waiting for government decision and few houses are difficult to do correction. Most of the non-compliance issues in the area are house constructed before technical person in the area and some have the issue of access attic height. It was reported that socio technical assistance provided by technical persons in the ward was found to be satisfactory in supporting beneficiaries in reconstruction. Overall, 95% of reconstruction work has been completed in the ward.
- **Tripurasundari Rural Municipality, Dhading, 27 February:** it was reported that some households are not still registered through grievance process and delay in result has caused misunderstanding among community and municipal/ward representatives. It was found that some vulnerable beneficiaries, single woman and disabled have not started to build houses due to difficulty in getting timely information on reconstruction as well as access to banks and other services. In case of non-compliant houses constructed before the deployment of technical persons, municipal office was requested to send the list of those houses to DLPIU. There was also discussion regarding the distribution of completion certificates in wards with higher reconstruction rate.
- **Hariharpurgadhi Rural Municipality, Sindhuli, 5 March:** it was reported that grievance list has not been received by the municipality although few beneficiaries have signed the PA. Beneficiaries are facing challenge due to slow banking process and not giving priority to the government reconstruction grant process. Further, there seemed a lack of coordination between municipal representatives and technical persons.
- **Ward 8, Hariharpurgadhi Rural Municipality, Sindhuli, 6 March:** there are households willing to change from retrofit to full reconstruction beneficiaries. Beneficiaries have constructed timber structure houses but have not been able to access third tranche of government grant. A lack a coordination between ward and municipalities with low mobility of technical persons in the field. Also, due to land issues (Elani/Government), beneficiaries have not been able to start reconstruction.
- **Ward 11, Kamalamai Municipality, Sindhuli, 7 March:** it was reported that 11 beneficiaries could not start reconstruction due to remoteness and transportation inaccessibility. 3 landless households were identified, and information sent to NRA for granting land, but the issue has not been addressed. It seems that the progress with the third tranche is slow with increase in timber structure construction. Among the 222 beneficiaries, 206 were included in grievance list, 51 in full reconstruction and 155 in retrofit list.

- **Jwalamukhi Rural Municipality, Dhading, 11-14 March:** it was reported that only 3 – 8% beneficiaries are remaining to reconstruct houses. Some of the major concerns were delay in disbursement of grant by the banks to the beneficiaries, few genuine beneficiaries not being included in NRA list. Municipal office requested NRA to carry out reverification and include the missed ones in the list. Further, municipal office also suggested if reliable banks could be open at an appropriate location to facilitate services to the beneficiaries for smooth reconstruction. The meeting was also conducted in **ward 5, Jwalamukhi Rural Municipality, Dhading** where the Chief mentioned that the households that were affected by the Budhi Gandaki hydro power have started getting final tranche to construct temporary structure. Budhi Gandaki hydro power project has also distributed compensation to the affected people.
- **Ward 16, Lalitpur Metropolitan City, Lalitpur, 13 March:** there are 795 beneficiaries out of which 721 have done PA with government received first tranche while only 119 have received second and 57 have received third tranches. 126 of the full reconstruction beneficiaries have applied to switch to retrofit beneficiaries, 27 of them already received first tranche of retrofitting. The main reconstruction issues in the ward related to small parcel land, cases of multiple beneficiaries and issues of land ownership papers. Majority of beneficiaries have confusion over retrofitting. They are taking retrofitting works as repairing works. The current building typology in reconstruction practice includes frame structure buildings. Many beneficiaries have not started reconstruction as they have not been able to demolish the old houses due to poor economic condition as well as fear of damage to adjacent non-beneficiaries houses.
- **Helambu Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok, 14 March:** main issues discussed were grievance result not being addressed. Reconstruction of the Gumbas almost 100 years old have not been addressed by the NRA yet. Helambu Rural Municipality Chief has not yet signed the MOU with the NRA. To check the presence of the field engineers, Rural Municipality Chief demanded a full control over the technical staff deployed by NRA, not only the attendance verification but also control over the salary and transfers as well. There are few beneficiaries who do not have houses elsewhere, are earthquake affected but are listed as having house in other places. Few houses constructed before the deployment of technical persons are non-compliant and beneficiaries do not want to apply correction measures. Lack of coordination, delay in tranche release and low remoteness allowance were also some of the issues raised during the meeting.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Weekly District Report, 15 Feb – 14 Mar 2019



Gangajamuna Rural Municipality, Dhading: two storey, hybrid structure, brick and cement mortar masonry in ground floor and CGI sheet in first floor. The floor area is less than 1,000 sq.ft. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Gorkha, Weekly District Report, 15 Feb – 14 Mar 2019



Ward No. 1, Ajirkot Rural Municipality, Gorkha: one room, stone and mud mortar masonry house with RCC bands. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok, Weekly District Report, 15 Feb – 14 Mar 2019



Ward No. 9, Roshi Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: two storey, stone and mud mortar masonry house. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhuli, Weekly District Report, 15 Feb – 14 Mar 2019



Ward No. 1, Harharpurgadhi Rural Municipality, Sindhuli: two storey, timber frame structure with stone in cement mortar in ground floor and light timer planks in first floor. The home owner has received second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and was advised to add cross bracing to be eligible to receive the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Weekly District Report, 15 Feb – 14 Mar 2019



Ward No. 5, Tripurasundari Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok: single storey, two roomed load bearing brick and cement mortar masonry house with CGI roofing. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

Case Studies

Return of First Tranche, Gorkha: the HRRP team in Gorkha spoke by phone with 20 households that have returned the first tranche (9 households from Palungtar Municipality, 6 from Gandaki Rural Municipality, 2 from Gorkha Municipality, 1 from Barpak RM, 1 from Sulikot RM, and 1 from Siranchowk RM). The team asked each household why they had returned the tranche and they found that 30% have another house in a different area, 60% are living in their pre-earthquake house, and 10% have not been able to start rebuilding because they don't have enough money.



Mr. Khadka Bahadur Thapa, from Palungtar Municipality, returned the first tranche because he was worried that he would be “blacklisted” if he didn’t build his house now. He does not want to rebuild at this time because he is supporting his sons; one to study hotel management and the other to travel to Macau for work. He is living at his brother’s house and is planning to rebuild his own house once his sons are earning money and can support themselves.

Mr. Aita Singh Thing, Chaughare, Konjosyom Rural Municipality, Ward No. 1, Lalitpur: Mr. Thing is 74 years old and lives with his wife. They have 5 daughters and 3 sons who live separately with their families. Mr. Thing, who is illiterate, has been earning his living through animal husbandry and selling milk in the village for many years. His two room, single storey, stone and mud mortar masonry house was completely destroyed by the 2015 earthquake and for nearly 1.5 years after the earthquake Mr. Thing and his wife lived in a temporary shelter. Mr. Thing then came in to contact with the Rural Institution for Community Development (RICOD) which provided him with 50,000 NPRs worth of construction materials as the vulnerable top-up (Mr. Thing was considered vulnerable due to his age). He has now successfully managed to rebuild his house and he spent nearly 600,000 NPRs in total. The new house is a two room, one storey, stone and mud mortar masonry house and he has also built a toilet. Mr. Thing shared that a large portion of the money spent on the construction was used to purchase water. One of Mr. Thing’s sons lives in the same area and he also provided support for the reconstruction of his father’s house. Mr. Thing has now received all of three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.



Mr. Aita Singh Thing stands in front of his rebuilt house in Chaughare, Konjosyom Rural Municipality, Ward No. 1, Lalitpur.

Mr. Birman Lopchan, Chaughare, Konjosyom Rural Municipality, Ward No. 1, Lalitpur: Mr. Lopchan is 40 years old and lives with his wife and his three children. He earns a living through daily wage labour. His one room, one storey house was completely destroyed by the 2015 earthquake. Mr. Lopchan and his family lived in a temporary shelter after the earthquake. The Rural Institution for Community Development (RICOD) provided top-up support in the form of 50,000 NPRs worth of construction materials. Mr. Lopchan has now completed construction of a one room, one storey house and he shares that the top up support and technical assistance provided by RICOD was a great contribution to this. Mr. Lopchan spent nearly 350,000 NPRs on the construction of his house and has now received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.



Mr. Birman Lopchan's house in Chaughare, Konjosyom Rural Municipality, Ward No. 1, Lalitpur.



Mr. Sarjan Nagarkoti, Naya Gaun, Danchhi, Kageshwori Manahara Municipality-4, Kathmandu:

Mr. Nagarkoti is 36 years old and has been working as a head mason in his village for the last 6 years. He started his profession as a normal labour based mason. He has received basic training on constructing houses from Sano Thimi Technical School many years back. He visited the ward office in Danchhi a number of times to request that a 7 day masons training be organised for masons working in the area. The ward office worked with the NSET Baliyo Ghar Programme to organise a 7 day training and Mr. Nagarkoti was able to participate. He found the experience very beneficial and felt that it advanced his knowledge and capacity as a mason. He shared that he learned about increasing the strength of a house by keeping 2 numbers of rings (1 each extra) in the tie beam, while in his earlier work he has put only 1 ring in the tie beam. Before taking part in the training he already had a good track record having built 18 houses, with the majority of them receiving the third tranche of the GoN's housing reconstruction grant. He is really pleased that he took the initiative to request this training opportunity through the ward office and having completed it he feels that households can be assured of his ability as a head mason who can build earthquake resilient houses.

Featured Technical Staff Person, Nashrul Haque Mansoor: Nashrul Haque Mansoor is originally from Parsa and has been working as an inspection engineer in Ward No. 5, Kamalamai Municipality, Sindhuli since 25 April 2016. In addition to carrying out inspections and providing technical support to households and masons, Nashrul is the reconstruction focal point for Kamalamai Rural Municipality. His experience of working on the reconstruction has been positive, especially as households and masons have been very open to his advice and have constructed accordingly. Most of the houses in his working area are load bearing structures built from brick masonry and cement mortar, RCC frame, or timber frame. Nashrul has taken part in a Training of Trainers on masons training, as well as orientations on the Correction and Exceptions Manual, Light Timber/Steel Frame Structure Manual, and the Retrofitting Manual. He shares that the ToT helped him to understand the practical application of good construction practices and the building code requirements. The orientation on the Corrections and Exceptions Manual has helped him to support households with the application of corrections for non-compliant houses. The training on the Light Timber/Steel Frame Structure Manual has been particularly important as it helped him to inspect timber frame houses, of which there are many in the area. He shares that they had been urgently awaiting the timber frame manual so that households that rebuilt using timber frame could be progressed through the reconstruction programme.

Nashrul shared that one of the challenges faced in the reconstruction is that there are buildings that were constructed after the earthquake but that weren't registered with the municipality and weren't supervised by NRA engineers. He worked with the households to support them to register their construction with the municipality and compliant buildings were forwarded for the tranche payments and for non-compliance buildings solutions were provided. Nashrul has been facilitating regular meetings in the municipality on approval of a design for timber structures but they still haven't finalised the process. Nashrul has supported households that were not included on the list of eligible households to be included in the resurvey and reverification process. He shared that poor workmanship was a big problem, but he has been working with masons on site to provide guidance and has delivered masons training. There are households with land issues which are holding up their reconstruction. Nashrul has been working with these households to try and support them to purchase land under the NRA policy for landless households.

He feels the reconstruction policies and guidelines developed by the NRA, as well as awareness programmes for households, masons training, and mobilisation of technical staff have been useful in ensuring safer reconstruction by creating awareness amongst everyone involved of what is required and the benefits of building back better.



Nashrul Haque Mansoor running a mason training programme in his working area.

GoN Products

[Causes Behind Delays in Housing Reconstruction Progress in the Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Programme \(EHRP\), A Study of Rural Municipalities of Lalitpur, NRA Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist for Lalitpur, Okhaldhunga, and Rasuwa:](#) for more information please contact Yam Nath Giri, Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist, National Reconstruction Authority, District Level Project Implementation Unit (Grant Management and Local infrastructure), Lalitpur, Rasuwa and Okhaldhunga, Phone: 01-5544379, Mobile No: 9851239785, email: yamnathgiri2014@gmail.com, yamnathgiri2009@yahoo.com.

[Revisions to the Grant Disbursement Procedures for Private Houses Destroyed by the Earthquake, Nepali and Unofficial English Translation](#)

HRRP Products

[HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey Round 4 Report](#)

5W Products are prepared based on the [latest round of 5W data, as of 25 January 2019](#). **Housing reconstruction progress maps** are prepared based on Building CLPIU data as of 5 March 2019.

Milijuli Nepali, Episode 1211: this episode is an interview with Mr. Sushil Gyawali, CEO of the National Reconstruction Authority. The programme also includes pre-recorded clips from Bhojpur and Sindupalchowk sharing the issues that households and engineers face with regard to retrofitting. Mr. Gyawali shares that the government has already started the process of providing training to 3,000 engineers and will carry out 1,000 demo retrofits. He provides information on what retrofitting is and the process involved and discusses the retrofitting of Singha Durbar. The CEO says that all types of houses can be retrofitted, but that it requires specific techniques, depending on the damage of the house. He also encourages listeners to seek support from the ward offices.

Baliyo Ghar TV, Episode 135: this episode is focused on the reconstruction and regeneration of Dwalkha Bazaar in Dolakha and also looks at the overall progress on regeneration of historical and archeological settlements throughout earthquake affected areas. The episode includes interviews with Mr. Bharat KC, Bhimeshwar Municipality Mayor, and Mr. Surya Narayan Shrestha, NSET Executive Director.



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